

Because I don't know much about the inner workings of cars (nor do I really want to), a trustworthy car repairman is just about as important as a good hairdresser in my mind. They make hard to understand concepts easier to grasp, and won't convince you that a very expensive part needs to be replaced, when clearly, you can get a few thousand more miles out of it.

Thankfully, we've been lucky enough to find one we trust. It's a little bit of a drive, but our confidence in his abilities makes it worth the service and the price. Ask around to see who friends and family trust, or carefully read through reviews on [Yelp.com](https://www.yelp.com). You want someone who cares about your car as much as, if not more than, you do!

2. **PERFORM PREVENTATIVE MAINTENANCE**

Regularly scheduled tune-ups like oil changes, tire pressure checks, tire rotation, and brake checks will make your car last much longer. You don't have to go crazy with these, as sometimes shops like to get you in the door and upsell you on excessive maintenance packages (see point #1). But you *should* check your car manual for each manufacturer's recommended maintenance schedule, just to be safe.

These items help prevent bigger and more expensive issues from happening down the road and are non-negotiable if you want a car that lasts. For example, if you don't change the oil often enough, your engine could seize up and not work at all. At that point, you have to make the decision to either replace the engine or get a new car—they're *that* expensive!

Sometimes it's hard to remember exactly when to do these regularly scheduled tune-ups (or even know what's included). To download a Car Maintenance Checklist with all the recommended to-dos, be sure to visit

[CreativeSavingsBlog.com/ExpenseResources](https://www.creativesavingsblog.com/expenseresources)

A few things listed on there are best left to a professional, but many can be done yourself for a fraction of the price.